



Scholiqen

LEARN • PRACTICE • EXCEL

— One Platform. Every Subject. Limitless Future. —



LEARN



SIMULATE



PRACTICE



CBT EXAMS



AI TUTOR



TRACK PROGRESS

COURSE MATERIAL

for

BOOK-KEEPING

COPYRIGHT

© 2026 Scholiquen Learning Platform. All Rights Reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, transmitted, distributed, or copied in any form or by any means—electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, scanning, or otherwise—without the prior written permission of the copyright holder, except for brief quotations used for educational review, research, or other purposes permitted by applicable copyright law.

This study guide has been prepared primarily for educational and academic purposes to support teaching, learning, and independent study. Every effort has been made to ensure the accuracy and reliability of the information contained herein. However, the publisher and authors accept no responsibility for any errors, omissions, or consequences arising from the use of this material.

Students are encouraged to complement this study guide with lectures, laboratory practicals, recommended textbooks, and other approved academic resources for a more comprehensive understanding of the course.

Published by:
Scholiquen Learning Platform

Website: <https://scholiquen.com>

Email: scholiquen@gmail.com

First Edition: 2026

All rights reserved

Study Guide

About This Study Guide

This Accounting Study Guide is designed to help students understand the basic principles and procedures involved in the preparation and use of cash books and the application of the double-entry principle.

The guide provides a structured approach to learning the single-column cash book, double-column cash book, contra entries, and the principles of double entry. Students are encouraged to study each section carefully, understand the rules involved, and practise preparing cash books and posting transactions to the ledger.

Course Overview / Course Aim / Course Objectives

This course introduces students to the fundamental concepts of cash books and double-entry bookkeeping. It provides students with the knowledge and skills required to record cash transactions accurately and apply the principles of double entry.

The course aims to help students:

- Understand the meaning and purpose of a cash book.
- Explain the measurement and basic structure of a single-column cash book.
- Identify the items recorded in a single-column cash book.
- Prepare a single-column cash book correctly.
- Understand the meaning and purpose of a double-column cash book.
- Identify the items recorded in a double-column cash book.
- Explain the differences between single-column and double-column cash books.
- Prepare a double-column cash book correctly.
- Explain the meaning of a contra entry.
- Identify and record contra entries in the cash book.
- Understand the meaning and principles of double-entry bookkeeping.
- Identify the accounts to be debited and credited in a transaction.
- Post transactions from the cash book to the ledger.
- Apply the rules of double entry when recording business transactions.

Major Topics Covered

- Meaning and measurement of the cash book.
- Single-column cash book.
- Items recorded in a single-column cash book.
- Preparation of a single-column cash book.
- Double-column cash book.
- Meaning of a double-column cash book.
- Items recorded in a double-column cash book.
- Difference between single-column and double-column cash books.
- Preparation of a double-column cash book.
- Contra entry.
- Identification and recording of contra entries.
- Principle of double entry.

- Meaning of double-entry bookkeeping.
- Identification of debit and credit accounts.
- Posting transactions from the cash book to the ledger.
- Rules of double entry.

Study Sessions

1. Cash Book

- Meaning and measurement of the cash book.
- Introduction to the cash book and its purpose.

2. Single-Column Cash Book

- Meaning of a single-column cash book.
- Items recorded in a single-column cash book.
- Structure and measurement of the single-column cash book.

3. Single-Column Cash Book

- Preparation of a single-column cash book.
- Recording cash receipts and payments.

4. Single-Column Cash Book

- Continued preparation of the single-column cash book.
- Practice in recording and balancing cash transactions.

5. Double-Column Cash Book

- Meaning of a double-column cash book.
- Items recorded in a double-column cash book.

6. Double-Column Cash Book

- Difference between a single-column and double-column cash book.
- Preparation of a double-column cash book.

7. Double-Column Cash Book

- Further preparation of the double-column cash book.
- Recording and balancing transactions involving cash and bank.

8. Contra Entry

- Meaning of a contra entry.
- Identification of contra entries.
- Recording contra entries in the cash book.

9. Principle of Double Entry

- Meaning of double-entry bookkeeping.
- Identification of the account to be debited.
- Identification of the account to be credited.

10. Principle of Double Entry

- Posting transactions from the cash book to the ledger.
- Rules of double entry.
- Application of double-entry principles to business transactions.

Background to the Course

Accounting is a branch of knowledge concerned with the systematic recording, classification, summarising, and interpretation of financial transactions. It provides individuals and organisations with information needed to understand their financial activities and make appropriate economic decisions.

The study of Accounting helps students understand how business transactions are recorded and how financial information is organised. One of the important areas of basic Accounting is the preparation and use of the cash book, which is used to record cash and bank transactions.

This study material introduces students to the basic concepts and procedures involved in preparing single-column and double-column cash books. Students will learn how to identify and record cash transactions, understand the difference between different types of cash books, and prepare them correctly.

The course also introduces students to contra entries and the principle of double entry. Students will learn how to identify accounts to be debited and credited and how transactions recorded in the cash book are posted to the appropriate ledger accounts.

Regular study, revision, and practical exercises will help students develop accuracy and confidence in recording financial transactions and applying the principles of double-entry bookkeeping.

Course Study Sessions

Session 1: Cash Book

Students will learn the meaning and purpose of a cash book. The session introduces the cash book as an important accounting record used for recording cash transactions and, where applicable, bank transactions. Students will also learn about the measurement and basic structure of a cash book and understand its importance in business record keeping.

Session 2: Single-Column Cash Book

Students will learn about the single-column cash book and its basic features. The session explains the items recorded in a single-column cash book, particularly cash receipts and cash payments. Students will examine the arrangement of the debit and credit sides and understand how cash transactions are entered into the book.

Session 3: Preparation of a Single-Column Cash Book

Students will learn how to prepare a single-column cash book. The session focuses on the correct recording of cash receipts and cash payments and the appropriate arrangement of transactions. Students will practise entering transactions and balancing the cash book correctly.

Session 4: Preparation of a Single-Column Cash Book — Continued

Students will continue to develop their skills in preparing a single-column cash book. The session provides further practice in recording different types of cash transactions, calculating balances, and ensuring that entries are made on the correct side of the cash book. Students will also practise identifying and correcting common errors in cash-book preparation.

Session 5: Double-Column Cash Book

Students will learn the meaning and purpose of a double-column cash book. The session explains how a double-column cash book provides separate columns for recording cash and bank transactions. Students will identify the items recorded in the different columns and understand how the double-column cash book is used in business accounting.

Session 6: Double-Column Cash Book

Students will learn the difference between a single-column cash book and a double-column cash book. The session explains the additional features of the double-column cash book and examines the treatment of cash and bank transactions. Students will also learn the basic procedure for preparing a double-column cash book.

Session 7: Preparation of a Double-Column Cash Book

Students will learn how to prepare a double-column cash book using appropriate accounting procedures. The session focuses on recording cash and bank transactions in their correct columns. Students will practise balancing the cash and bank columns and determining the appropriate closing balances.

Session 8: Contra Entry

Students will learn the meaning and purpose of a contra entry. The session explains transactions that affect both the cash and bank columns of the cash book, such as cash deposited into the bank or cash withdrawn from the bank for business use. Students will learn how to identify contra entries and record them correctly in the cash book.

Session 9: Principle of Double Entry

Students will learn the meaning and importance of the principle of double entry. The session explains the fundamental rule that every business transaction has a dual effect and must be recorded in at least two accounts. Students will learn how to identify the account to be debited and the account to be credited for different transactions.

Session 10: Principle of Double Entry

Students will continue studying the principles of double-entry bookkeeping. The session focuses on posting transactions from the cash book to the appropriate ledger accounts. Students will learn the rules governing debit and credit entries and practise applying these rules when recording and posting business transactions.

STUDY SESSION ONE: SINGLE-COLUMN CASH BOOK

1.0 INTRODUCTION

This session provides learners with a detailed explanation of the meaning, purpose, structure, and preparation of a single-column cash book. It introduces the cash book as an important accounting record used to record all transactions involving cash received and cash paid by a business.

The session also explains the relationship between the cash book and the ledger, the arrangement of the debit and credit sides, and the items commonly recorded in a single-column cash book. Students will learn how to identify cash receipts and cash payments and determine the appropriate side of the cash book on which each transaction should be recorded.

In addition, the session introduces the basic principles involved in preparing and balancing a single-column cash book. Students will examine the treatment of opening cash balance, cash receipts, cash payments, and closing cash balance. Practical examples will be used to develop students' ability to record transactions accurately and determine the balance of cash at the end of a given period.

Understanding the single-column cash book provides an important foundation for further study of double-column cash books, contra entries, ledger posting, and the principles of double-entry bookkeeping.

1.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES FOR THE STUDY SESSION 1

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- i. Define a cash book and explain its purpose in accounting.
- ii. Explain the meaning and importance of a single-column cash book.
- iii. Identify the main features and structure of a single-column cash book.
- iv. Identify the different items and transactions recorded in a single-column cash book.
- v. Distinguish between cash receipts and cash payments.
- vi. Explain the appropriate side of the cash book for recording cash receipts and cash payments.
- vii. Explain the meaning of opening and closing cash balances.
- viii. Prepare a simple single-column cash book from given business transactions.
- ix. Record cash transactions accurately in the appropriate columns.
- x. Balance a single-column cash book and determine the closing cash balance.

1.2. Topic: Single Column cash book

INTRODUCTION: This is the book for recording receipts and payments of money in cash or cheque.

NOTE: No credit transaction should be recorded in the cash book.

CASH ACCOUNT: This is the account which is used for recording money received and paid with cash. The balance is referred to as CASH IN HAND. All cash received must be debited while cash paid will be credited to the cash account.

Illustration 1:

Enter the following transactions in the cash account of Olaide

	₦
July 1 Cash in hand	1,500
July 3 Cash to Okola	250
July 5 Cash Sales	500
July 6 Cash purchases	700
July 7 Bought Stationery	50
July 9 Paid Insurance	30
July 10 Paid wages	25
July 12 cash sales	155

SOLUTION

DR		CASH ACCOUNT	CR	
	₦		₦	
July 1 bal. b/f	1,500	July 3 Okola	250	
July 5 sales	500	July 6 Purchaser	750	
July 12 sales	115	July 7 Stationery	50	
		July 9 Insurance	30	
		July 10 wages	25	
		Bal. c/d	1,010	
	<u>2,115</u>		<u>2,115</u>	

BANK ACCOUNT: The bank account is a record of money deposited into the bank and money withdrawn from the bank. All cheques received must be debited while cheques issued out must be credited.

Illustration 2:

Enter the following transactions in the bank account of Ogundele.

	₦
June 1 Cash in hand	2,500
June 3 Paid to Okocha by cheque	650
June 5 Sold goods and received cheque	450
June 6 Received Cheque from Agali	230
June 7 Sent Cheque to Komolafe	
June 9 Bought goods with cheque	300

SOLUTION

DR		BANK ACCOUNT		CR	
	₦		₦		
June 1 bal. b/f	2,500	July 3 Okocha	650		
June 5 sales	450	July 6 Purchaser	750		
June 6 sales	230	July 7 Stationery	50		
		July 9 Insurance	30		
		July 10 wages	25		
Bal. b/d 1,910		Bal. c/d	1,010		
	<u>3,180</u>		<u>3,180</u>		

STUDY SESSION TWO: DOUBLE-COLUMN CASH BOOK

2.0 INTRODUCTION

This session provides learners with a detailed explanation of the meaning, purpose, structure, and preparation of a double-column cash book. It introduces the double-column cash book as an important accounting record used to record transactions involving cash and bank.

The session explains how the double-column cash book differs from the single-column cash book and highlights the additional column provided for recording bank transactions. Students will learn how cash receipts, cash payments, deposits, withdrawals, and other relevant transactions are recorded in the appropriate columns.

The session also explains the major items found in a double-column cash book and the correct treatment of cash and bank transactions. Students will learn how to identify the appropriate side and column for each transaction and how to maintain accurate accounting records.

Furthermore, the session introduces the procedures involved in balancing the cash and bank columns. Practical examples will be used to help students develop the ability to prepare a double-column cash book correctly and determine the balances of cash and bank at the end of an accounting period.

A clear understanding of the double-column cash book provides an important foundation for studying contra entries, ledger posting, and the principles of double-entry bookkeeping.

2.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES FOR THE STUDY SESSION 2

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- i. Define a double-column cash book and explain its purpose in accounting.
- ii. Explain the meaning and importance of a double-column cash book.
- iii. Identify the main features and structure of a double-column cash book.
- iv. Identify the items and transactions recorded in a double-column cash book.
- v. Explain the difference between a single-column and a double-column cash book.
- vi. Distinguish between cash transactions and bank transactions.
- vii. Identify the appropriate side and column for recording cash and bank transactions.
- viii. Explain the treatment of cash deposited into the bank and cash withdrawn from the bank.
- ix. Prepare a double-column cash book from given business transactions.
- x. Balance the cash and bank columns and determine the appropriate closing balances.

2.2 DOUBLE COLUMN CASH BOOK

Meaning: The two column Cash book so-called because for both debit and credit entries, it has two columns, one for recording cash transactions and the other for bank transactions. It is therefore used for recording mixed cash and bank transaction.

Accounting Entries

All payments in cash are recorded by crediting the cash column of the cash book. If the payment is by cheque the bank column is credited.

When cash is withdrawn from the bank (e.g for paying wages and sundry expenses), the cash column is debited and the bank column is credited with the amount involved.

Example:

Record the following transactions in a two column cash book. Balance the cash book and bring down the balances of cash in hand and cash at bank at the end of the period.

19x9

April 2: Introduced N2,900 cash into the business as capital

April 4: Paid N1,850 of the capital into bank

April 10: Cash purchases N300

April 15: Cash sales N450

April 20: Purchases by cheque N700

April 25: Cash sales N650

April 28: Office expenses paid for in cash N30

April 29: Cash paid into bank N1,000

April 30: Wages paid by cheque N75.

STUDY SESSION THREE: CONTRA ENTRY

3.0 INTRODUCTION

This session provides learners with a detailed explanation of the meaning, purpose, identification, and recording of contra entries in the cash book. It introduces the concept of a contra entry as a transaction that affects both the cash and bank columns of a double-column cash book.

The session explains the circumstances under which contra entries occur, particularly when cash is deposited into the bank or when cash is withdrawn from the bank for business purposes. Students will learn how these transactions involve both cash and bank and therefore require entries on both sides of the cash book.

The session also explains how contra entries are identified and recorded using the appropriate accounting procedure. Students will learn the importance of the contra symbol and understand why such transactions do not require separate posting to another ledger account.

Furthermore, practical examples will be used to help students identify contra transactions and record them correctly in the double-column cash book. The session will develop students' ability to distinguish contra entries from ordinary cash and bank transactions.

A clear understanding of contra entries provides an important foundation for the proper preparation of double-column cash books and the application of the principles of double-entry bookkeeping.

3.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES FOR THE STUDY SESSION 3

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- i. Define a contra entry and explain its meaning in accounting.
- ii. Explain the purpose and importance of contra entries in a cash book.
- iii. Identify transactions that give rise to contra entries.
- iv. Distinguish between contra entries and ordinary cash or bank transactions.
- v. Identify cash deposited into the bank as a contra transaction.
- vi. Identify cash withdrawn from the bank for business use as a contra transaction.
- vii. Explain why a contra entry affects both the cash and bank columns.
- viii. Identify the contra symbol used when recording contra entries.
- ix. Record contra entries correctly in a double-column cash book.
- x. Explain why contra entries do not require separate posting to another ledger account.

3.2 CONTRA ENTRY

Contra is a Latin word which shows that cash has been withdrawn from the office and deposited in the bank or withdrawals of cash from bank for office use.

It is an entry involving the payment of cash into the bank and is denoted by “C” in the folio column.

It may simply be defined as the transfer of an account to the identical side of another account.

a. Payment of cash to bank.

When too much cash is in the office, the whole or part of it can be paid into the bank.

Effect

Cash balance is decreased

Bank balance is increased

Action Required

Cr. Cash column

Dr. Bank column

E.g: Jan. 1 cash balanced N300

Jan. 2 cash paid into the bank amounted to N710

Dr					Cr				
Cash Book									
Date	Particulars	Folio	Cash	Bank	Date	Particulars	Folio	Cash	Bank
			₦	₦				₦	₦
Jan. 1	Cash	C		300	Jan. 1	Bank	C	300	
Jan. 2	Cash	C		710	Jan. 2	Bank	C	710	

Note: “C” must be put on both sides to represent contra entry.

b. Withdrawals from bank for office use.

When there is no sufficient cash in the office to meet payments, cash can be withdrawn from bank. When this occurs, the effect and action will be started below.

Effect

Bank balance will decrease

Cash balance will increase

Action Required

Cr. Bank column

Dr. Cash column

E.g: Jan. 4 withdrew cash ₦800 from bank for office use.

Dr

Cr

Date	Particulars	Folio	Cash	Bank	Date	Particulars	Folio	Cash	Bank
			₦	₦				₦	₦
Jan. 4	Bank	C	800		Jan. 4	Cash	C		800

STUDY SESSION FOUR: PRINCIPLE OF DOUBLE ENTRY

4.0 INTRODUCTION

This session provides learners with a detailed explanation of the principle of double entry, which is one of the fundamental principles of accounting. It introduces the concept that every financial transaction has two aspects and must be recorded in at least two accounts, with one account being debited and another being credited.

The session explains the meaning and importance of double-entry bookkeeping and shows how the system provides a complete record of the financial effects of business transactions. Students will learn how transactions affect different accounts and how the principles of debit and credit are applied when recording business activities.

The session also introduces the basic rules used to determine which account should be debited and which account should be credited. Students will learn to analyse transactions, identify the accounts involved, and apply the appropriate debit and credit treatment.

Furthermore, practical examples will be used to help students understand the application of double-entry principles to common business transactions. The session will develop students' ability to analyse transactions systematically and record them accurately.

A clear understanding of the principle of double entry provides an important foundation for preparing ledger accounts, trial balances, and other financial accounting records.

4.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES FOR THE STUDY SESSION 4

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- i. Define the principle of double entry and explain its meaning in accounting.
- ii. Explain the importance of the double-entry system in recording business transactions.
- iii. Explain why every transaction has two accounting aspects.
- iv. Identify the accounts affected by a business transaction.
- v. Explain the meaning of debit and credit.
- vi. Identify the account to be debited in a given transaction.
- vii. Identify the account to be credited in a given transaction.
- viii. Apply the basic rules of debit and credit to business transactions.
- ix. Record simple business transactions using the principle of double entry.
- x. Explain how the double-entry system provides a complete record of business transactions.

4.2 PRINCIPLE OF DOUBLE ENTRY

Definition: Double entry book keeping is the system of keeping account, which take advantages of the two-fold aspect of every transaction, whereby one account that receives is debited and another account, which gives, is credited.

The following simple rules of double entry should be fully understood and memorized.

- a. for every credited entry in an account there must be a corresponding debit entry in another account.
- b. For every debit entry in an account, there must be a corresponding credit entry in another account.
- c. All transactions must be recorded in two accounts, one account is debited and another account credited.

APPLICATION OF THE PRINCIPLES OF DOUBLE ENTRY

1. Any transaction involves two accounts.
 - a. Receiving account or receiver.
 - b. Giving account or giver.
- a. Dr. Receiving account } With value it receives
- b. Cr. Giving account } With value it gives out.

Illustration: Complete the following table. Account to be.

		Debited	Credited
i.	Start business with ₦800 cash	Cash	Capital
ii.	Goods sold on credit to Mr. Ayo	Ayo	Sales
iii.	We paid creditor Mr. Olu by cheque	Mr. Olu	Bank
iv.	Goods bought by cheque	Purchases	Bank
v.	Sold goods for cash	Cash	Sales
vi.	Goods were returned to Mr. Kufor	Kufor	Returns Outwards
vii.	Biodun lent us ₦80 cash	Cash	Loan (Biodun)
viii.	Took ₦20 of the cash and paid into the	Bank	Cash

	bank		
ix.	Bought a motor van by cheque	Motor van	Bank
x.	Goods were returned to Olotu	Olotu	Returns Outwards
xi.	Paid further cash into the business as capital	Cash	Capital

4.3 POSTING OF TRANSACTIONS FROM CASH BOOK TO LEDGER

POSTING TO THE LEDGERS.

Posting is the act of using one book as a means for entering the items to other accounts so as to complete double entry. When applying the principle of double entry, students are advised to write up the cash book first and then transfer to the ledgers.

Rules to be followed

1. All items on the debit side of the cash book must be transferred to the credit side of individual ledgers.
2. All items on the credit side of the cash book must be posted to the debit side of individual ledgers

Illustration:

Enter the following in a two column cash book. Balance off at the end of the month and post to all necessary ledgers.

June 1: Started business with cash ₦3,200

June 2: The following paid us by cheque, Okon ₦500 : Abbey ₦600

June 3: Cash sales paid directly into the bank ₦400

June 5: Paid rent by cash ₦180

June 6: We paid the following account by cheque; Sope ₦520 :Ladi ₦300

June 7: Withdrew cash from the bank for business use ₦70

June 8: Commission received by cheque ₦450

June 10: Banked cash ₦150

June 12: Withdrew cash from bank for personal use ₦30

June 15: Paid wages by cash ₦250

June 16: Bought motor van by cheque ₦20

June 18: Cash sales N1,000
June 20: Bought stationery paying by cash N170
June 22: Received N200 cheque from Okete
June 23: Cash purchases N550
June 24: Cash drawings N120
June 25: Bought goods by cheque N115
June 27: Yinka lend us N1,020 cash.
June 28: Paid motor expenses by cheque N18
June 30: The proprietor put further cash N1,320 into the business as capital.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write up the two column cash book in simplified and amplified book-keeping and accounting page 56 revision question 5x.
Note: Post the entries from the prepared two column cash to all relevant ledger account
2. You are required to write up the accounts for the following transactions.

Jan. 1	Started business with N12,000 in the bank.
Jan. 2	Bought stationery on credit from Okete N200
Jan. 3	Bought goods on credit from Ogundele N3,000
Jan. 6	Paid rent in cash N30
Jan. 8	Sold goods on credit to Ajala N500
Jan. 12	We returned goods to Ogundele N150
Jan. 19	Paid wages in cash N30.